

New AI Tool Approval Checklist

Tool under consideration: [TOOL NAME]

Requesting team / owner: [TEAM / OWNER]

Date: [DATE]

Completed by: [NAME]

Use this checklist before approving a new AI tool for company work. It is meant for quick triage, not a full vendor review.

1. Basic purpose

☐ What does the tool do?

[SHORT DESCRIPTION]

☐ What problem does it solve?

[PROBLEM / USE CASE]

☐ Who will use it?

[TEAM / ROLES / NUMBER OF USERS]

☐ Is there already an approved tool that does this?

[YES / NO / EXPLAIN]

2. Data check

What data will users enter? Check all that apply:

- ☐ Public information only
- ☐ Internal business information
- ☐ Customer personal data
- ☐ Employee personal data
- ☐ Health, financial, biometric, children's, or government ID data
- ☐ Source code, contracts, pricing, trade secrets, or confidential business information
- ☐ Third-party data received under NDA or contract

Stop and escalate if anything sensitive, confidential, regulated, or personal will be entered.

3. Use check

☐ Will output be shown directly to customers, clients, patients, students, applicants, employees, or the public?

- ☐ No

- ☐ Yes — describe: [DESCRIPTION]

☐ Will the tool make or materially influence decisions about people?

- ☐ No

- ☐ Yes — describe: [DESCRIPTION]

☐ Will the tool connect to company systems, files, email, CRM, HR, support, finance, production code, or databases?

- ☐ No

- ☐ Yes — describe: [DESCRIPTION]

Escalate before approval if any answer is yes.

4. Vendor check

☐ Vendor has a public privacy policy.

☐ Vendor has clear terms of service.

☐ Vendor explains whether customer inputs are used for model training.

☐ Vendor explains data retention and deletion.

☐ Vendor uses encryption in transit.

☐ Vendor has reasonable security information available, such as SOC 2, ISO 27001, security page, or equivalent.

☐ Pricing and contract terms are clear.

☐ Exit path is clear if the company stops using the tool.

5. Decision

Recommended action:

☐ Approve for limited use

☐ Approve with conditions

☐ Needs full vendor/risk review

☐ Reject

☐ Need more information

Conditions, if any:

[CONDITIONS]

Approved by: [NAME]

Date: [DATE]

Next review: [DATE]

6. If approved

- ☐ Add tool to the AI Tool Inventory.
 - ☐ Add tool to the approved tools list.
 - ☐ Tell users what data may and may not be entered.
 - ☐ Configure SSO/MFA if available.
 - ☐ Schedule review date.
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Educational/legal boundary

This template is for educational and informational purposes only. It is not legal advice and does not create an attorney-client relationship. Review with qualified counsel before adopting it for your organization.